LESSON 5

Mary had a little lamb

A rhyme by Sarah Josepha Hale, first printed in Boston in 1830, about a lamb that followed a girl to school. We sing it to the tune of *Merrily we roll along*.

IN THIS SONG **4/4** **crotchet, minim, semibreve** **C position** **steps and a skip** **chords C and G**

1 Say and clap

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.
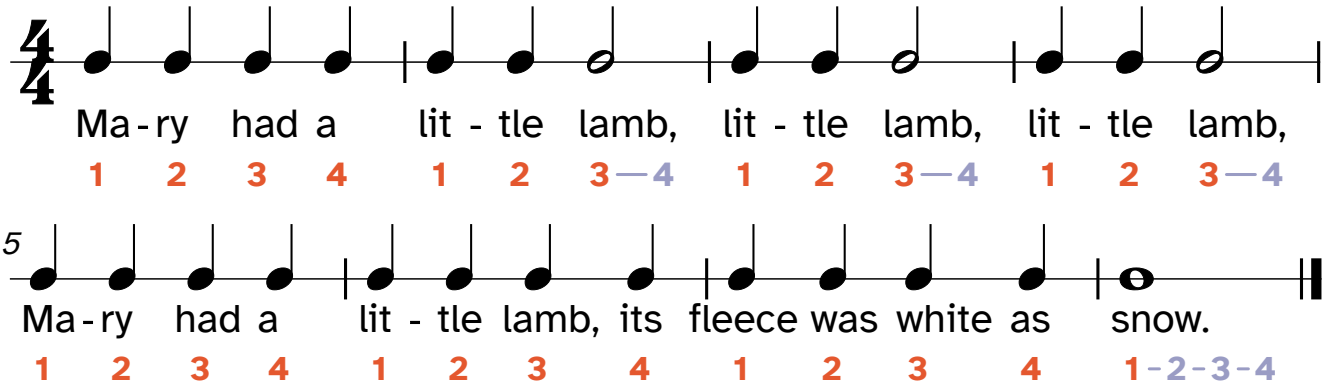
THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

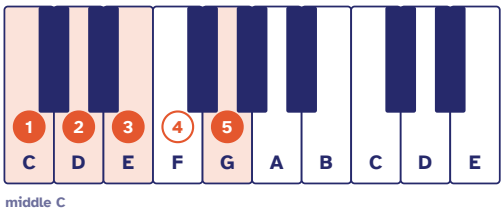
crotchet — 1 beat ●
minim — 2 beats ●●
semibreve — 4 beats ●●●●



☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped and counted** ☐ **Found every minim (2 beats)**

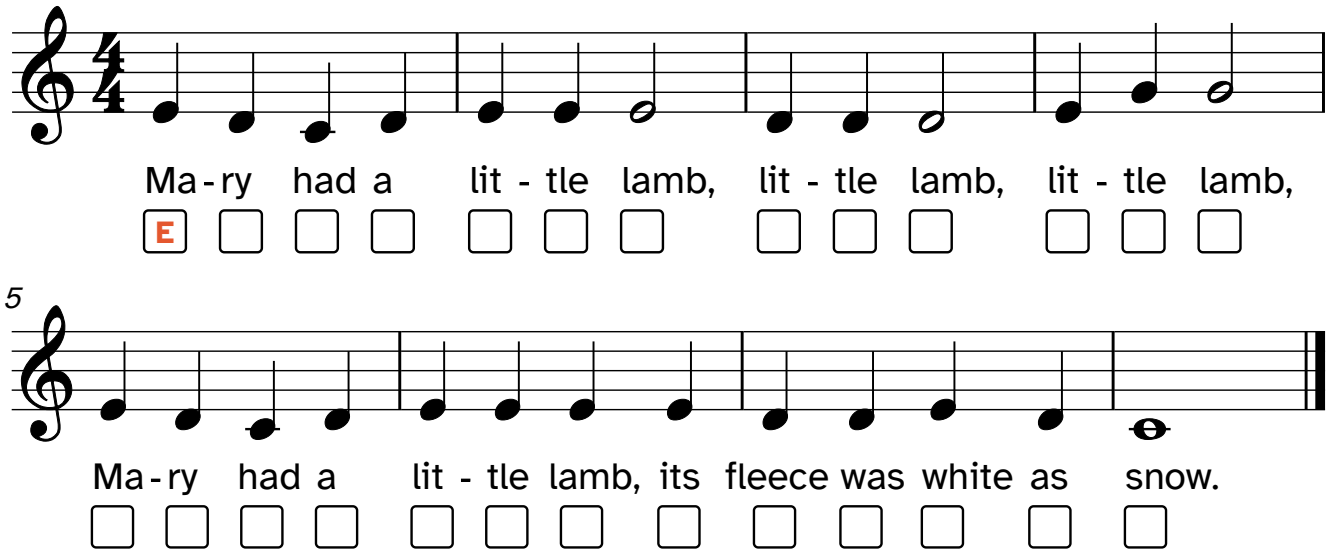
2 Listen and sing

Listen first, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing. Write the letter name of every note in the boxes; the first one is done.



Your hand: C position. Right thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G. The song's notes are lit.

Steps and a skip. Most notes move by a step, to the next key. Only once does the tune skip a key: E up to G. In which bar? ☐



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words** ☐ **Wrote the letter names** ☐ **Found the skip**

SCAN ME

3 Play it four ways

Each way adds a little more for the left hand. Your teacher tells you which is yours this week.

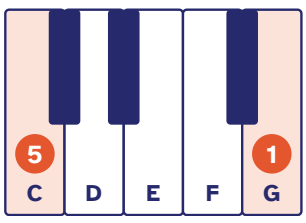
WAY 1 ★☆☆☆ **The tune** — Right hand alone. The numbers above the notes are your fingers.

WAY 2 ★★☆☆ **Hold the root** — Left hand, row 2. A chord is named after its root: C with finger 5, G with finger 1. Hold it all bar.
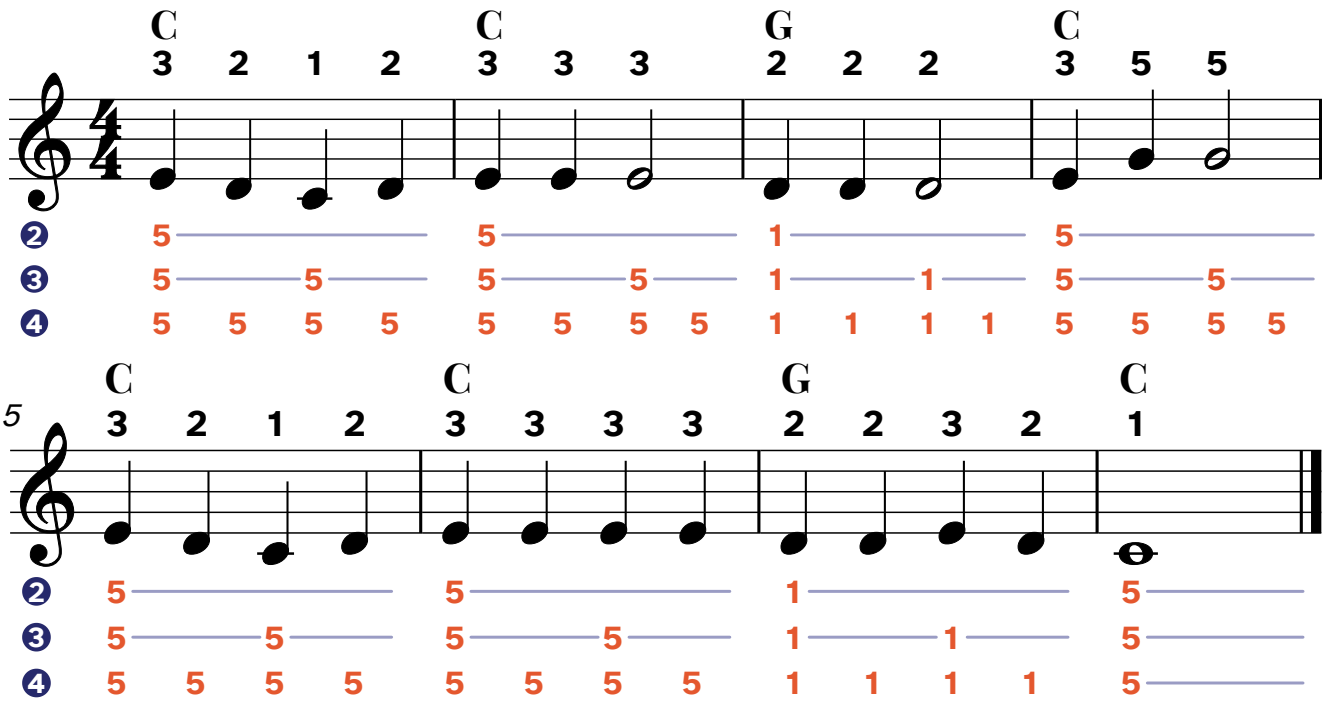
WAY 3 ★★★☆ **Root on 1 and 3** — Row 3: the same root, played on beats 1 and 3.

WAY 4 ★★★★ **Root on every beat** — Row 4: the root on every beat, while the right hand plays the tune.

LEFT HAND
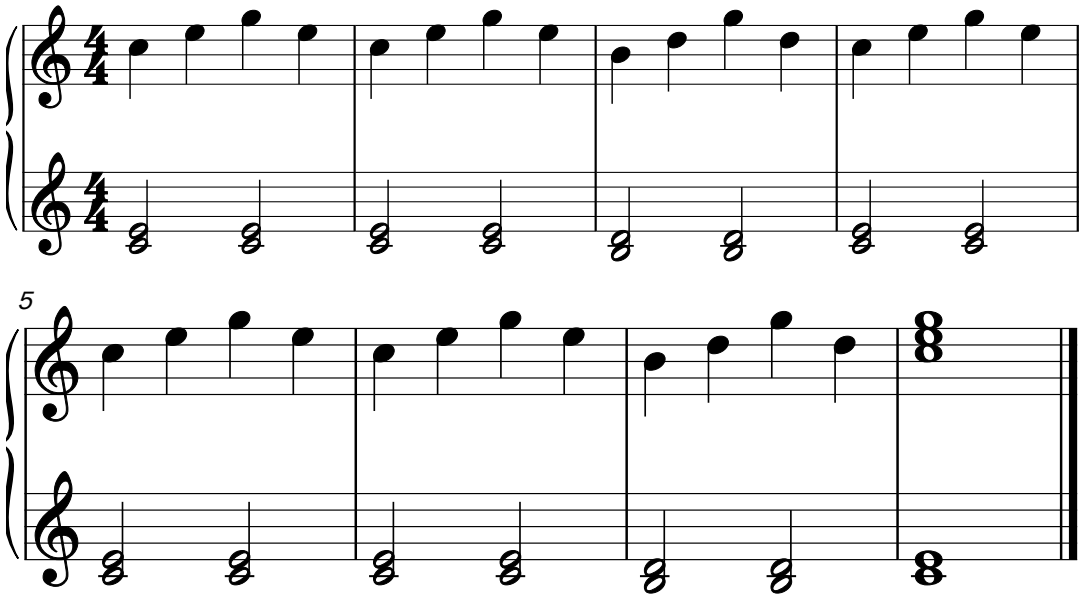


roots: C 5, G 1



PLAY TOGETHER with your teacher, who plays this an octave higher, or with a friend: one plays Way 1, the other a left-hand row. Then swap.

TEACHER



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can name its notes

I can play it:

☐ Way 1 ☐ Way 2 ☐ Way 3 ☐ Way 4

TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet